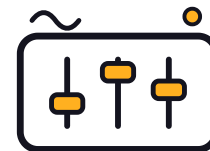


FOR THE TEACHER

Teacher Guide & Answer Key

Robots Do the Boring Work — suggested sorts, discussion moves, the Defense Rubric, and full standards text.



WHY THIS LESSON

Students hear "AI is taking the jobs" everywhere, usually as a scare. This lesson swaps the fear for a decision-making frame: **let the robots do the boring work; leave the humans to do the human things.** The honest middle-school version: AI changes jobs more than it deletes them, and every automation choice carries a tradeoff (CSTA 2-IC-20) — that conversation is the intellectual core; the studio is just a stage cool enough to hold it. Student pages say "the trade."

SUGGESTED SORTS — READ THIS FIRST

Honest note: most of these tasks are defensibly AUGMENT. The column matters far less than the defense — a pair that puts D in KEEP HUMAN and names a real tradeoff beats a pair that matches this table with no reason. Grade the trade, not the column.

TASK	LIKELY COLUMN	THE TRADEOFF WORTH SURFACING
A — Session reminder texts	Automate	Wins hours back; a chirpy text after a cancellation stings.
B — Rename + back up files	Automate	Nobody misses it; the risk is silent failure, so spot-check.
C — Draft social captions	Augment	AI drafts fast, but the studio's voice is Jaylen's.
D — Rough demo mix	Augment	AI gets most of the way; Ravi's ears are the product.
E — Coach a nervous artist	Keep human	Confidence is the product; outsource it and the artist loses.
F — Payment reminders	Automate	A job nobody wants; a loyal regular gets a cold nudge.
G — Pick the single	Keep human / Augment	Taste is Nia's edge; AI reports what's trending, doesn't decide.
H — Fix the echoey room	Keep human / Augment	Craft plus judgment; AI can suggest, hands do the work.
I — Agree on a price	Keep human	Trust and reading the room; a bot can cost the client.
J — Type up lyrics	Automate	Pure transcription; it can mishear a bar — the artist checks.
K — Same five email questions	Automate	Same answers daily; the risk is the sixth question.
L — Plan showcase night	Keep human / Augment	The vibe is live connection; AI can draft the checklist.

DISCUSSION MOVES (FOR THE HARD QUESTIONS)

Q: "Will AI take my mom's job?" — Stay honest, no predictions: "Some parts of almost every job will get automated — usually the repeating parts. Jobs mostly change shape instead of disappearing. The real question: which parts are the human parts? That's your exit ticket."

Q: The class splits three ways on one task — who's right? — Nobody, and say so. Push with: "Convince me. Who wins? Who loses? What breaks?" A three-way split is the best share-out material.

Q: "Isn't automating a task mean to whoever did it?" — Sit in that tension; it IS the standard. Nia, the new helper, who loses the boring texts also loses a way to learn every client's name. Naming both sides out loud is the skill.

DEFENSE RUBRIC — DEFEND THE BOARD (SL.6.4)

- **Proficient:** one clear claim, a specific detail from the task, names who wins AND who loses or what breaks; audible, looking at the room.
- **Developing:** claim plus a reason, but the trade is missing or vague ("it's just faster").
- **Beginning:** restates the column with no because, or reads to the desk.

EXIT TICKET EXEMPLAR

The job: my uncle's food truck. **Automate:** posting the truck's daily location to socials. **Augment:** planning how much food to buy each week — AI predicts, he decides. **Keep human:** joking with the regulars at the window, because that's why they come back.

FULL STANDARDS TEXT

- **CSTA 2-IC-20** — Compare tradeoffs associated with computing technologies that affect people's everyday activities and career options. *Taught: Direct Instruction, the tradeoff lens worked example. Assessed: Trade Cards (worksheet p.2) and Exit Ticket.*
- **CCSS ELA SL.6.4** — Present claims and findings, sequencing ideas logically and using pertinent descriptions, facts, and details to accentuate main ideas or themes; use appropriate eye contact, adequate volume, and clear pronunciation. *Taught: claim-frame modeling in the Share-Out setup. Assessed: Defend the Board, scored with the Defense Rubric above.*
- **ISTE 1.3.d** — Students build knowledge by actively exploring real-world issues and problems, developing ideas and theories and pursuing answers and solutions. *Taught: The Studio Task Board sort (real tasks, real business). Assessed: Exit Ticket, applying the sort to a real job in their life.*

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